

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 789

By Todd

A RESOLUTION to recognize Arthur D. Johnson, Jr., for his honorable and astute service to the people of Madison County and the State of Tennessee.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should specially recognize those estimable public servants who have dedicated themselves to improving the quality of life for their fellow citizens; and

WHEREAS, Arthur D. Johnson, Jr., is one such estimable person, who has demonstrated the greatest dedication, ability, and integrity as a public servant in Madison County for sixty-five years; and

WHEREAS, Commissioner Arthur D. Johnson, Jr., was born on July 19, 1937, in Malesus and grew up in the same home where his father was born; he attended Malesus grammar school and graduated from Malesus High School in 1955; and

WHEREAS, Commissioner Johnson is a third-generation, lifelong farmer in Madison County, growing cotton, corn, soybeans, and wheat. He married Sarah Maddox in 1967 and raised his two children, Arthur "Chip" D. Johnson III and Jill Johnson in Madison County; and

WHEREAS, he joined the Tennessee Army National Guard, 30th Division, 230th Signal Company in 1955 and served until 1963, earning the rank of Sergeant E-5; he earned the Marksmanship Badge Carbine Expert, signifying the highest level of skill using a carbine rifle; and

WHEREAS, Commissioner Arthur Johnson took an interest in public service at a young age and ran for the Madison County Quarterly Court in 1960; he began his representation of the Malesus and South Jackson area as a member of the Madison County Quarterly Court, now the Madison County Board of Commissioners, on September 1, 1960; and

WHEREAS, the longest-serving county commissioner in the history of the State of Tennessee, Commissioner Johnson has now served Madison County for over sixty-five years; and

WHEREAS, during his tenure as a member of the Madison County Quarterly Court and the Madison County Board of Commissioners, Commissioner Johnson has served on almost every committee, including a tenure as chair of the Financial Management Committee; and

WHEREAS, an active part of his community, he has served as Deacon and Sunday School Director at Malesus Baptist Church, director and vice president of the Madison County Farm Bureau, vice president of the Malesus Men's Civic Club, and co-founder of the Madison South Jaycees Club with his brother-in-law, Joe Nip McKnight; and

WHEREAS, Commissioner Johnson has served as district and state director for the Jaycees, been a member of the Madison County Co-Op board of directors, and recognized as the Young Farmer of the Year by the Junior Chamber of Commerce; and

WHEREAS, Arthur Johnson has proven himself to be wholly committed to the noble precepts of public service that have earned Tennessee recognition as the Volunteer State, and he should be specially recognized for his many years of honorable and astute service to the citizens of Madison County; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we hereby honor and commend Arthur D. Johnson, Jr., on his sixty-five years of dedicated public service to the people of Madison County and the State of Tennessee.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.